
RESIDENTIAL LEASE AGREEMENT

State of California — Fixed-Term Tenancy

LANDLORD	TENANT
Margaret L. Thornton	Daniel R. Okafor
4821 Cedarwood Drive	Current Address: 109 Pine Street, Apt 3B
Sacramento, CA 95814	Oakland, CA 94607
Phone: (916) 555-0192	Phone: (510) 555-0348
Email: mthornton@email.com	Email: dokafor@email.com

1. PREMISES

Landlord hereby leases to Tenant the residential premises located at **2204 Rosewood Avenue, Unit 7, Sacramento, California 95820** (hereinafter referred to as "the Premises"). The Premises is a two-bedroom, one-bathroom apartment of approximately 850 square feet. Tenant shall use the Premises solely for residential purposes and shall not conduct any commercial activity thereon without prior written consent of Landlord.

2. LEASE TERM

This Agreement shall commence on **October 1, 2026** and shall terminate on **September 30, 2027**, constituting a fixed-term tenancy of twelve (12) months ("the Term"). Upon expiration of the Term, if neither party provides written notice of termination at least thirty (30) days prior to expiration, this Agreement shall automatically convert to a month-to-month tenancy under the same terms and conditions.

3. RENT

3.1 Monthly Rent. Tenant agrees to pay Landlord the sum of **\$1,850.00 (One Thousand Eight Hundred Fifty Dollars)** per month as rent for the Premises.

3.2 Due Date. Rent is due and payable on the **1st day of each calendar month**. Rent shall be deemed late if not received by the 5th day of the month.

3.3 Late Fee. If rent is not received by the 5th day of the month, Tenant shall pay a late fee of **\$75.00**. If rent remains unpaid after the 10th day of the month, an additional fee of \$10.00 per day shall accrue until payment is received.

3.4 Payment Method. Rent shall be paid by electronic bank transfer to Landlord's designated account, or by personal check made payable to Margaret L. Thornton. Cash payments will not be accepted.

4. SECURITY DEPOSIT

4.1 Amount. Upon execution of this Agreement, Tenant shall deposit with Landlord the sum of **\$3,700.00 (Two months' rent)** as a security deposit.

4.2 Return. The security deposit shall be returned to Tenant within **21 days** following the termination of tenancy and surrender of the Premises, subject to deductions for unpaid rent, cleaning costs, and repair of damages beyond normal wear and tear.

4.3 Itemized Statement. If any deductions are made, Landlord shall provide Tenant with an itemized written statement of deductions along with any remaining balance.

5. UTILITIES AND SERVICES

Tenant shall be solely responsible for payment of the following utilities: electricity, gas, internet, and cable television. Landlord shall be responsible for water, sewer, and trash collection services. Landlord shall maintain the Premises in compliance with applicable housing codes, including functioning heating and hot water systems.

6. MAINTENANCE AND REPAIRS

6.1 Landlord Obligations. Landlord shall maintain the structural components of the Premises, including roof, walls, plumbing, heating, and electrical systems, in good working order. Landlord shall respond to emergency repair requests within **24 hours** and non-emergency requests within **7 business days**.

6.2 Tenant Obligations. Tenant shall keep the Premises in a clean and sanitary condition, dispose of all trash properly, and promptly notify Landlord of any needed repairs. Tenant shall be responsible for the cost of repairs necessitated by Tenant's negligence or misuse.

7. PETS

No pets of any kind shall be kept on the Premises without the prior written consent of Landlord. If Landlord consents to a pet, Tenant shall pay a non-refundable pet fee of **\$300.00** per pet and an additional pet deposit of **\$500.00** per pet, which shall be refundable subject to the conditions of Section 4.2.

8. ALTERATIONS AND IMPROVEMENTS

Tenant shall make no alterations, additions, or improvements to the Premises without prior written consent of Landlord. Any approved alterations shall become the property of Landlord upon termination of tenancy unless Landlord requires restoration, in which case Tenant shall restore the Premises to its original condition at Tenant's expense.

9. TERMINATION

9.1 Notice by Tenant. Tenant may terminate this Agreement upon providing **30 days' written notice** prior to the end of the fixed term. Early termination before the lease end date shall result in forfeiture of the security deposit and Tenant remaining liable for rent through the earlier of: (a) the end of the term, or (b) the date a replacement tenant approved by Landlord takes occupancy.

9.2 Termination by Landlord. Landlord may terminate this Agreement for: (a) non-payment of rent after a 3-Day Notice to Pay or Quit; (b) material breach of this Agreement after a 3-Day Notice to Cure or Quit; (c) repeat violations after a 3-Day Unconditional Quit Notice; or (d) at expiration of the term with 30 days' notice.

10. LANDLORD'S RIGHT OF ENTRY

Landlord shall provide Tenant with at least **24 hours' advance written notice** before entering the Premises, except in cases of emergency. Landlord may enter during normal business hours (8:00 AM – 6:00 PM) to make repairs, show the unit to prospective tenants or buyers, or conduct an inspection.

11. GOVERNING LAW AND DISPUTE RESOLUTION

This Agreement shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of the **State of California**. Any disputes arising under this Agreement shall first be subject to good-faith mediation. If mediation fails, disputes shall be resolved in the Sacramento County Small Claims Court or Superior Court, as appropriate.

12. ENTIRE AGREEMENT

This Agreement constitutes the entire agreement between the parties with respect to the Premises and supersedes all prior negotiations, representations, or agreements. Any modifications to this Agreement must be in writing and signed by both parties.

SIGNATURES

LANDLORD

TENANT

Margaret L. Thornton

Date: _____

Daniel R. Okafor

Date: _____

This document was prepared for demonstration purposes only and does not constitute legal advice. Consult a qualified attorney before signing any lease agreement.